SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #6 · RACE, ETHNICITY AND LANGUAGE

“People like me will never be treated fairly.”

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Where it often comes from

For many, unfair treatment is not a theory: it is experience, from jokes, suspicion, being passed over, or worse. Family stories of injustice add weight. After enough hurts, “never” can feel like realism. This belief deserves to be handled with respect, because injustice is real.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not minimize injustice. God says, “Learn to do right; seek justice and correct the oppressor.” The psalmist writes, “You have heard, O LORD, the desire of the humble… You will incline Your ear, to vindicate the fatherless and oppressed.” Hagar, a mistreated outsider, called God “the God who sees me.” Amos cries, “Let justice roll on like a river.” God sees, hears, and will judge justly, and He calls His people to act. The word “never” goes beyond what is true: God’s justice is coming, and good people in every community work for it.

> *“You have heard, O LORD, the desire of the humble; You will strengthen their hearts. You will incline Your ear, to vindicate the fatherless and oppressed, that the men of the earth may strike terror no more”* (Psalm 10:17–18).

Also see

> “So Hagar gave this name to the LORD who had spoken to her: ‘You are the God who sees me,’ for she said, ‘Here I have seen the One who sees me!’” (Genesis 16:13).

> “Learn to do right; seek justice and correct the oppressor. Defend the fatherless and plead the case of the widow” (Isaiah 1:17).

> “But let justice roll on like a river, and righteousness like an ever-flowing stream” (Amos 5:24).

> “He has shown you, O man, what is good. And what does the LORD require of you but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God?” (Micah 6:8).

Common self-statements

- The system is rigged against people like me.
- No matter what I do, I will be judged first by my background.
- Fairness is not for us.
- There is no point in trying.
- They will never see us as equal.
- Things will never change.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that unfairness will always win.
- Overgeneralizing: Assuming everyone will treat me unfairly.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining no good outcomes at all.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling hurt and concluding that hope is foolish.

Challenging questions

- What real experiences of unfairness have I had, and how have they affected me?
- Where have I also been treated with respect or fairness?
- What does God say about justice and the oppressed?
- What can I do, even in small ways, to seek justice or support others?
- Who around me offers solidarity or understanding?
- How can I stay hopeful without denying the pain?

Truth summary

> Injustice is real, and God sees it. He hears the humble and promises justice. I can grieve, speak up where I can, and work with others for fairness, without letting "never" take away my hope.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Persecution
- Hopeless
- Prejudice
- God, All Loving
- Suffering

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Suffering
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Greater — MercyMe
God's presence and grace challenge shame and the need to win everyone's approval.

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People like me will never be treated fairly"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People like me will never be treated fairly." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What unfair experiences have I had?
- ☐ Where was I treated fairly?
- ☐ What does God say about justice?
- ☐ What can I do?
- ☐ Who understands?
- ☐ How can I stay hopeful?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God sees me.
- ☐ God hears the humble.
- ☐ God commands justice.
- ☐ Injustice is real and not the last word.
- ☐ I am not alone.
- ☐ I can hope and act.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 10:17–18**
  "You have heard, O LORD, the desire of the humble; You will strengthen their hearts. You will incline Your ear, to vindicate the fatherless and oppressed, that the men of the earth may strike terror no more."
- ☐ **Genesis 16:13**
  "So Hagar gave this name to the LORD who had spoken to her: 'You are the God who sees me,' for she said, 'Here I have seen the One who sees me!'"
- ☐ **Micah 6:8**
  "He has shown you, O man, what is good. And what does the LORD require of you but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God?"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Seen and heard: Each week, note one way you were treated fairly and one way you spoke up or supported someone.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 10:17–18 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God sees me and hears the humble.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Prejudice" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name the hurts. Write the experiences honestly with a trusted friend or counselor.
- ☐ Find community. Connect with others who understand.
- ☐ Take one action. Support a cause, speak up kindly, or mentor someone.
- ☐ Pray Psalm 10:17–18. Bring your grief and your hope to God.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People like me will never be treated fairly": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Hope and action
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People like me will never be treated fairly.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

God who sees, You know every unfair word and act. Hear the cry of the humble, bring justice, and give me courage and hope. Use me to bring Your fairness where I can. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.